FOODCHOW ENGINEERING

AI Support Agent Setup Guide

Local development instructions for Windows PowerShell

1. Prerequisites

- Python 3.11 or newer
- Node.js and npm
- MongoDB Atlas or a local MongoDB server
- A Gemini API key for AI-generated responses

2. Configure the backend

Run these commands from the repository root:

```
Set-Location "D:\FoodChow AI Support Agent"
Copy-Item .env.example .env
```

Edit the root `.env` file with values similar to the following:

```
APP_NAME=FoodChow AI Support Agent
ENVIRONMENT=development
DEBUG=true
BACKEND_HOST=127.0.0.1
BACKEND_PORT=8000
FRONTEND_URL=http://localhost:5173
MONGODB_URI=mongodb+srv://USERNAME:PASSWORD@CLUSTER.mongodb.net/?retryWrites=true&w=majority
MONGODB_DATABASE=foodchow_support
GEMINI_API_KEY=your_gemini_api_key
GEMINI_MODEL=gemini-3.6-flash
JWT_SECRET_KEY=generate_a_long_random_secret
ACCESS_TOKEN_EXPIRE_MINUTES=60
```

MongoDB Atlas

Create a database user, allow your IP in Network Access, and URL-encode special characters in the password.

Local MongoDB

Use `MONGODB_URI=mongodb://127.0.0.1:27017`. The application selects `foodchow_support` separately.

Credential warning: Never commit `.env`. Any credentials previously present in the working copy should be rotated before sharing or deploying: MongoDB password, Gemini API key, and JWT secret.

3. Install and run the backend

Keep the working directory at the repository root when starting Uvicorn; the imports use the `backend.app` module path.

```
Set-Location "D:\FoodChow AI Support Agent"
python -m venv .venv
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pip install -r .\backend\requirements.txt
uvicorn backend.app.main:app --reload --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8000
```

If PowerShell blocks activation: `Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process Bypass`, then activate again.

4. Install and run the frontend

Open a second terminal:

```
Set-Location "D:\FoodChow AI Support Agent\frontend"
npm install
npm run dev
```

Open `http://localhost:5173`. The frontend defaults to `http://127.0.0.1:8000`. For another backend URL, create `frontend/.env`:

```
VITE_API_BASE_URL=http://127.0.0.1:8000
```

5. Verify the installation

Purpose	URL or command
Backend health	`http://127.0.0.1:8000/health`
Interactive API documentation	`http://127.0.0.1:8000/docs`
Frontend	`http://localhost:5173`

6. Optional mock data and demo accounts

Seed the MongoDB collections from the repository's `mock_data` directory:

```
Set-Location "D:\FoodChow AI Support Agent"
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
python .\scripts\seed_database.py
```

> **Seeding behavior:** the script clears and reinserts the seeded collections. Do not run it against production data.

The backend creates these demo users if they do not already exist:

Role	Email	Password
Administrator	`admin@foodchow.com`	`DemoPassword123`
Support agent	`agent@foodchow.com`	`DemoPassword123`

Change or remove these credentials outside a local demonstration.

7. Tests and production checks

```
Set-Location "D:\FoodChow AI Support Agent"
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pytest

Set-Location .\frontend
npm run lint
npm run build
```

The root `docker-compose.yml` is currently empty, so Docker Compose is not configured for this project.

Generated for the FoodChow AI Support Agent repository. Keep secrets in environment variables and outside source control.